Project 1: Judging A Book By It’s Cover

Ziqi Zhou

VDES24178 Visual Design and Computation

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Design statement

The Alice's Adventures in Wonderland is aimed at modern young adult and literary-fiction readers and covers themes of identity fluidity, the absurdity of adult logic, and the perilous journey of curiosity. These themes are represented with a central keyhole portal from which a stream of narrative symbols.Like, a pocket watch, rabbit Cookies and cakes that change in size and a Cheshire Cat's grin emanates, etc. framed by intertwined white and red roses with thorns. This imagery signifies Alice's transformative fall from a mundane reality into a world where rules are arbitrary and the self is in constant flux, using the visual tropes of metaphor and symbolism.

First of all, I take the keyhole as the threshold between consciousness and subconsciousness, the known and the absurd. I think this becomes a powerful metaphor. Because it is both the physical starting point and the symbolic starting point of the entire adventure. The sequence of symbols emerging from the keyhole uses symbolic techniques to outline Alice's journey, visually narrating her experiences in chronological order and constructing a "map" of her constantly evolving experiences. Finally, the pair of intertwined yet opposing red and white roses symbolize the hidden conflicts between the two queens in the story, and their thorns allude to the potential threats and sharp social satire that run through the fantastical appearance of the fairyland. These elements jointly capture the duality of the novel. For instance, the captivating wonders and the disturbing chaos, I want the cover to imply inviting readers to embark on their own interpretation journey by peeping through the keyhole.



Title: Alice's Adventures in Wonderland
Author: Lewis Carroll
Genre: Fantasy, Children's Literature, Satire

Synopsis of the major themes:

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland tells the surreal journey of a young girl named Alice who impulsively follows a hurried white rabbit down a rabbit hole, plunging into a bizarre and fantastical world. In this upside-down realm governed by absurdity rather than logic, she encounters a series of eccentric characters, including the enigmatic Cheshire Cat, the Mad Hatter, and the tyrannical Queen of Hearts.

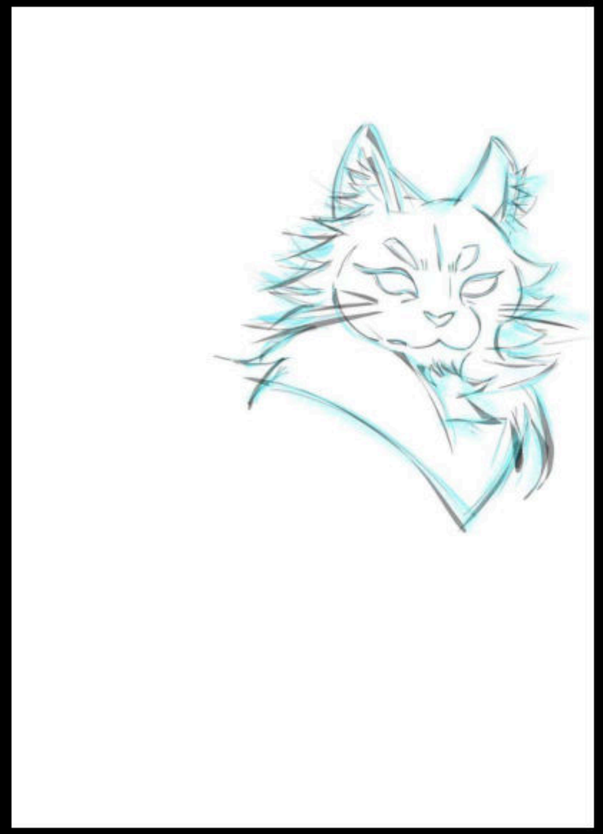
Throughout her bewildering adventures, Alice must navigate illogical challenges and shifting rules while grappling with an identity crisis triggered by randomly shrinking and growing after consuming various foods and potions. The novel presents a dazzling dreamscape that uses seemingly nonsensical whimsy to profoundly explore themes of childhood, curiosity, and the uneasy transition into adulthood.

Why is this book of importance to you?

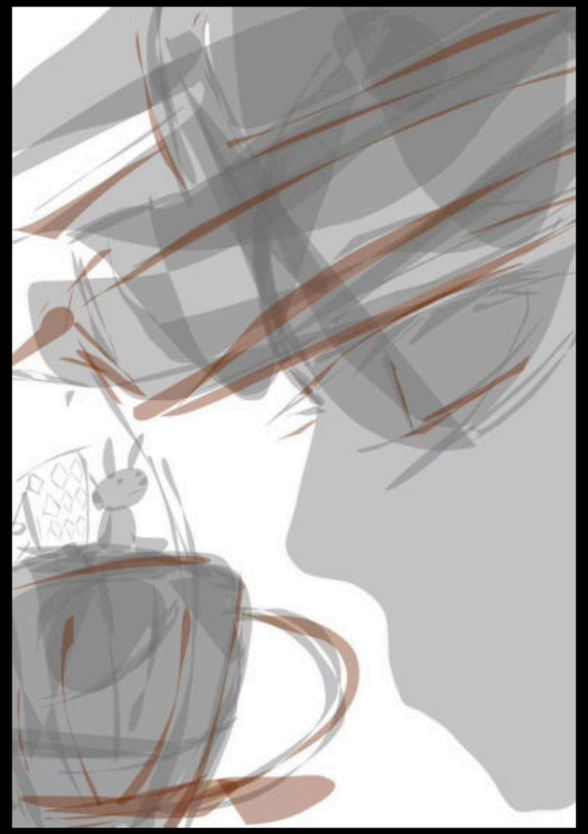
I think this book has taught me some truths about life. It encourages me to be as brave as Alice. It taught me that even if I'm afraid, I should keep a curious and brave heart to explore my own path. Rather than blindly accepting all the rules.

I think this book is more than just a fairy tale. It taught me in my childhood to view the world with curiosity and a critical eye, to see some absurd rules in it.

Book Research Project Exercise



This point was inspired by the Cheshire Cat. My idea is that kind of Cheshire cat with a transparent glass feel. I want to express that sense of visual space that extends infinitely and dissolves itself, just like the Cheshire Cat's ability to blend reality and illusion.



This point was inspired by the Mad Hatter. My idea was the moment when the Mad Hatter suddenly came to a standstill during the hustle and bustle of a party. All the exaggerated expressions on his face settled down, replaced by a profound, even sorrowful clarity. Because the Mad Hatters were cursed by time and forever trapped in the time cage of afternoon tea, it can be said that he was the only one who clearly perceived the pain of this eternal repetition. I want to express his silent cry for reason, his exhaustion from being trapped in eternity, and also his faint hope that Alice, this "outsider", could understand his situation.



My inspiration comes from the story. When Alice first followed the rabbit into the cave entrance, she ate the small cake and cookies inside, grew bigger and smaller, and then got the key. In my view, it is that key opening that is the origin of everything. Through this key opening, the door was opened, and thus one could enter that world. Only then can one meet the characters in the story. The roses respectively represent two queens. The thorns and leaves between them represent their attitudes towards each other. The picture also represents the order of the characters appearing, such as the rabbit, the clock, the cat, Alice, the Mad Hatted man, the book (Mr. Caterpillar), and the lanterns (everyone at the party), etc

Process work

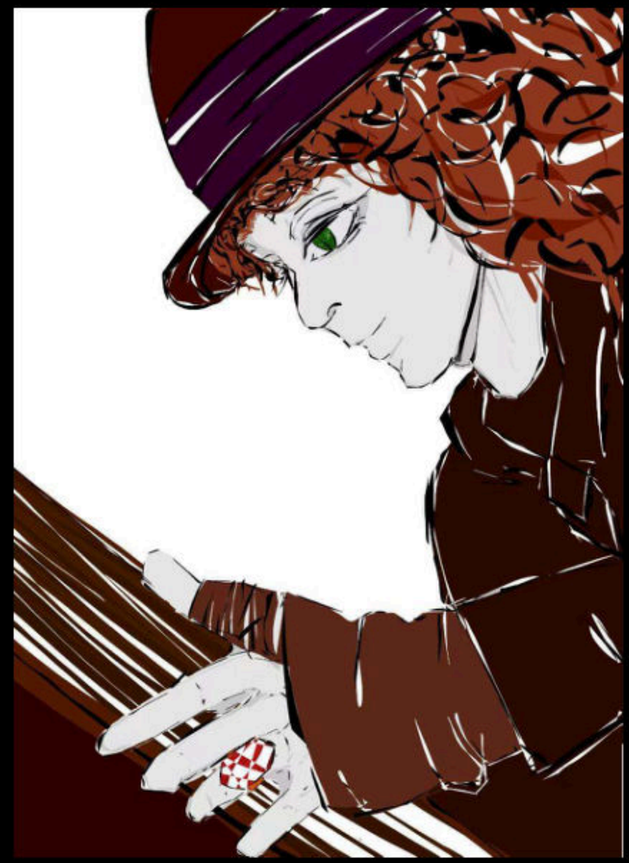
Book Research Project Exercise



What I want to convey in this scene is that the beginning of the story is caused by a late rabbit. In my view, it is not only the starting point of the story, but also a microcosm of the entire absurd world. So I drew rabbits and clocks.



On the basis of the original, I added characters from the forest, such as flower fairies, strange vegetative patients, and so on

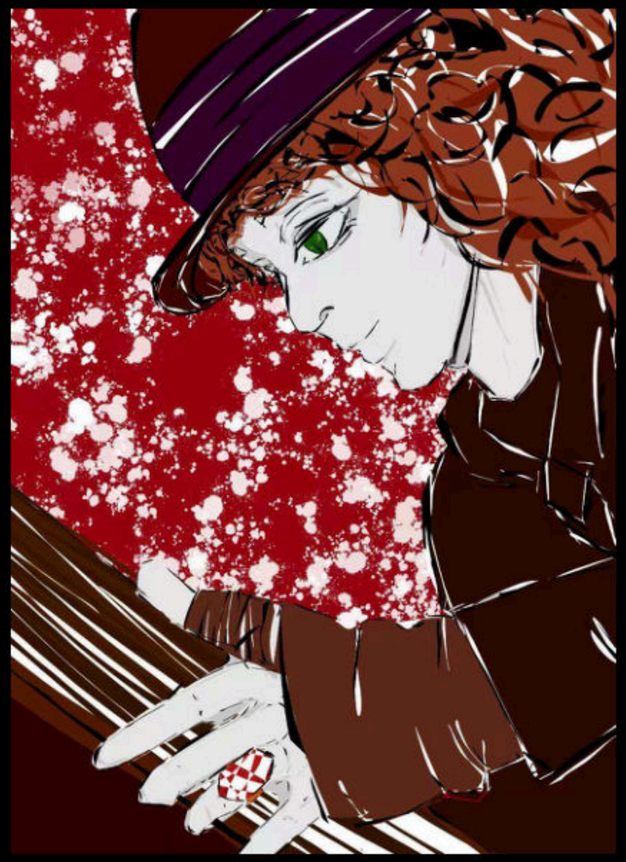


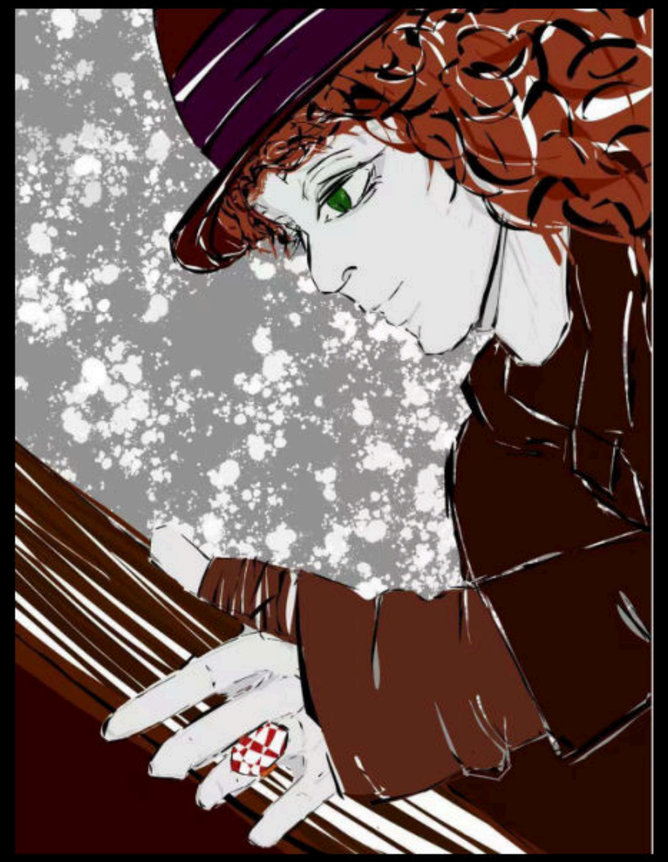
After watching the second Alice in Wonderland movie, I wanted to complete the regret of the Mad Hatter who was trapped in the past and kept repeating the afternoon tea. So I changed the content of the drawing to a scene of the Mad Hatter reuniting with his family. In the movie, the photo frame in the Mad Hatter's hand features his family members miniaturized by the Red Queen.

Process work

Book Research Project Exercise







Process work

Book Research Project Exercise







Process work

Book Research Project Exercise







Process work

Book Research Project Exercise







Process work

Art Direction



Movie: "Zombie Bride" (2005)

Uniqueness: I think Tim Burton presents the theme of death in such a melancholy, romantic and poetic way. Its pale and slender character designs, combined with the cold blue-green tones, create an aesthetic of a "beautiful freak".

Project impact: This film provided me with references for color tones and emotions in my design.



Movie: "Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Uniqueness: I think the visual signature of Tim Burton's version lies in the complexity and exaggeration of its Baroque style: the Mad Hatter's chaotic makeup, the Red Queen's huge head, and all kinds of strange and unconventional costumes.

Project impact: This film mainly influenced my thinking on character design. It encourages me to refine the character traits in an extreme and symbolic way.



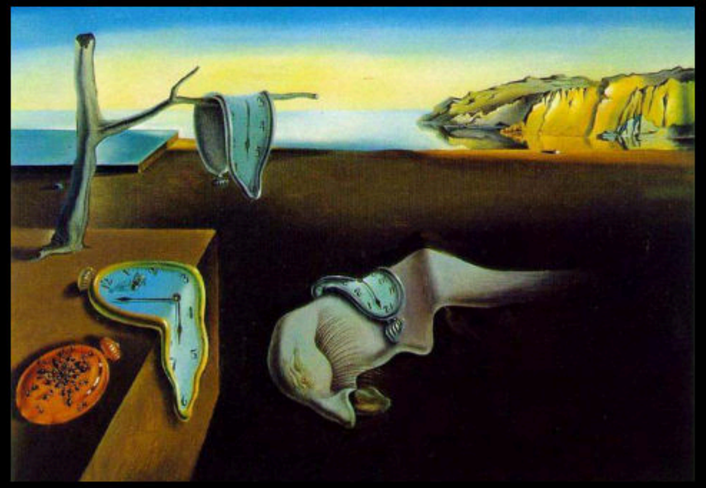
Movie: "Pan's Labyrinth"

Uniqueness: I think Guillermo del Toro seamlessly weaves the cruel reality with the cold and ancient fantasy. The fantasy creatures in it (such as Pan God and the Pale Monster) are not cute, but ancient, majestic and disturbing.

Project impact: I used the original novel of this film. This film has been of great help to my design inspiration. It strengthened my determination to present the "danger of the Wonderland" on the cover.

Process work

Art Direction



Art: Surrealist paintings by Salvador Dali

Uniqueness: I think Dali is more like directly depicting the dream itself. Its melted clocks, distorted Spaces and illogical juxtapositions are the products of the emergence of the subconscious after "rational sleep".

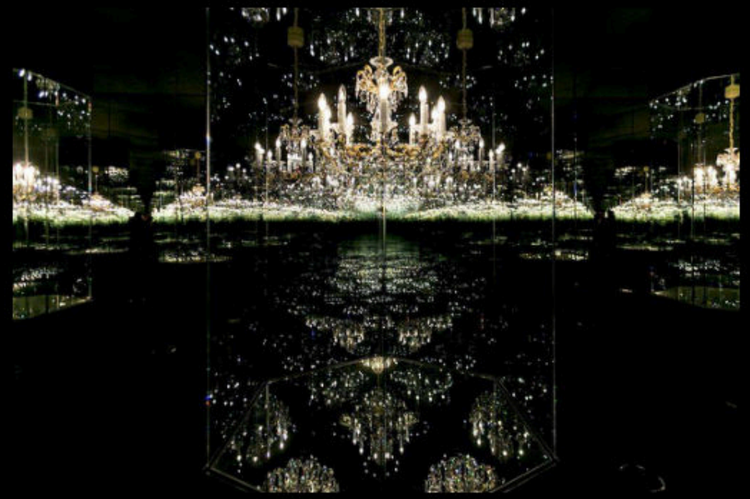
Project impact: This provided the most fundamental theoretical and visual basis for me to think about the core concept of "narrative elements flowing out of the keyhole".



Animation: "Spider-Man: Into the Spider-Verse"

Uniqueness: By watching this anime, I think the effect of creating a dynamic visual explosion that is "happening" by piecing together the dots of comics, the colors of pop art, and the fragmented feel of glitching art is very special.

Project impact: This anime has given me the courage to stylize and blend different visual elements.



Art: Yayoi Kusama's "Infinite Mirror House"

Uniqueness: This artist creates an infinitely extending and self-dissolving visual space through highly reflective materials and repetitive polka dots, blurring the boundary between reality and illusion.

Project impact: This provided an excellent reference for the fragmented feeling I had when creating the cover background, which made me think of using a mirror effect to create a sense of confusion and dizziness.

Process work

Art Direction



Movie: "Midsommar"

Uniqueness: By juxtsing the bright, splendid and folk pattern-filled "paradise" scene with the distressed expression of the figure in the center of the picture, an extremely disturbing beauty is created.

Project impact: I think this poster perfectly demonstrates how to create tension with "beautiful horror". This directly affected my handling of the red and white roses.



Album Cover: Radiohead "OK Computer"

Uniqueness: I think the use of collage, distorted visual elements and chaotic layout inside is very special. It gives me a sense of anxiety, alienation and disorder created in the era of technology.

Project impact: It encouraged me to infuse a sense of "absurdity of the digital age" into my design, such as everyone falling down, it implies Alice's "overload" in the new world and the mental confusion of accepting the new society.



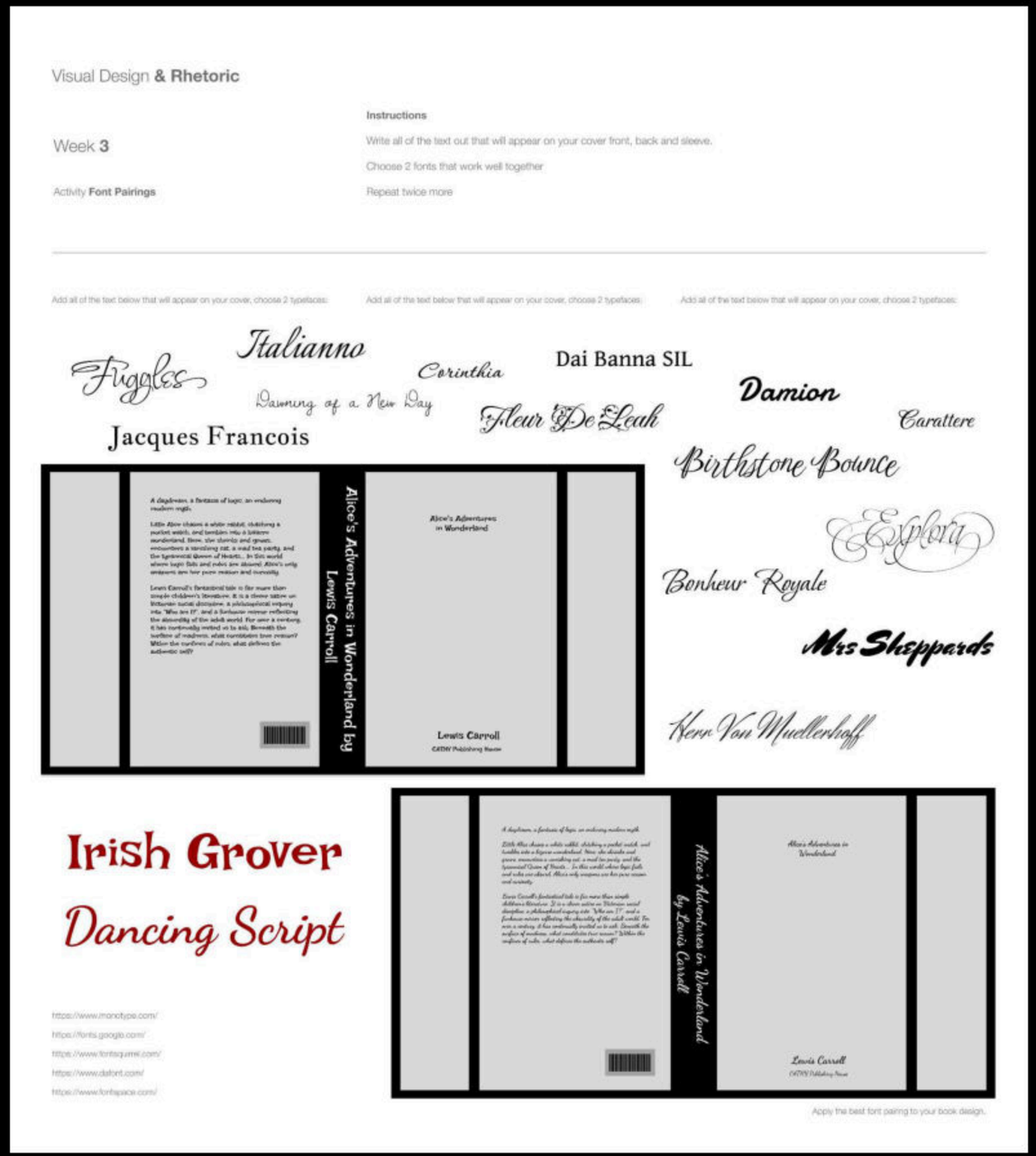
Movie: "Tenet"

Uniqueness: I believe that the visual concept of "time inverse entropy" runs through the entire film, with both the forward and reverse movements of characters and the environment coexisting, creating a unique audio-visual language that defies common sense.

Project impact: This film has provided me with a new perspective for presenting that "time" theme on the cover.

Process work

Art Direction



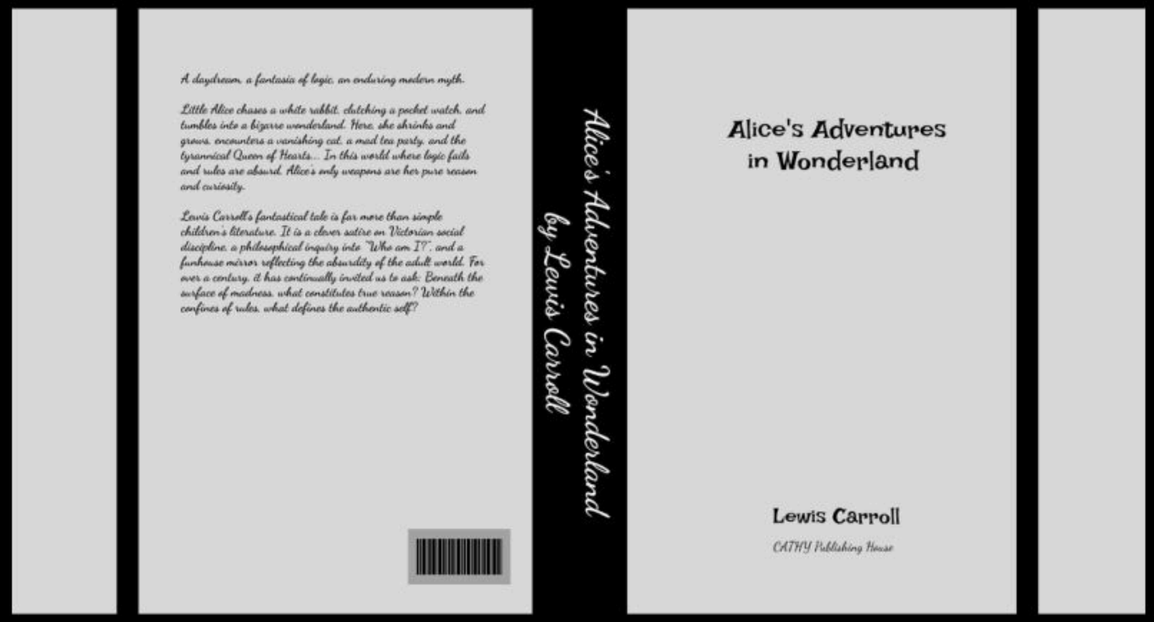
Irish Grover :
A visual statement of order, childhood and stability.
Dancing Script:
A visual statement of chaos, wonderland and flow.

Irish Grover is an all-capital sans-serif font with a strong woodcut style. Its characteristics are thick strokes, simple structure and irregular handcrafted edges, which remind people of children's building blocks or old-fashioned printed materials.

Why choose it:
I think this represents a symbol of childhood. This slightly childish and handcrafted style perfectly represents Alice's world as a child and the "playful" feel at the beginning of the story.
Visual "sturdiness" : Its thick strokes provide a solid and stable visual anchor point for the cover, just like the starting point of a story.

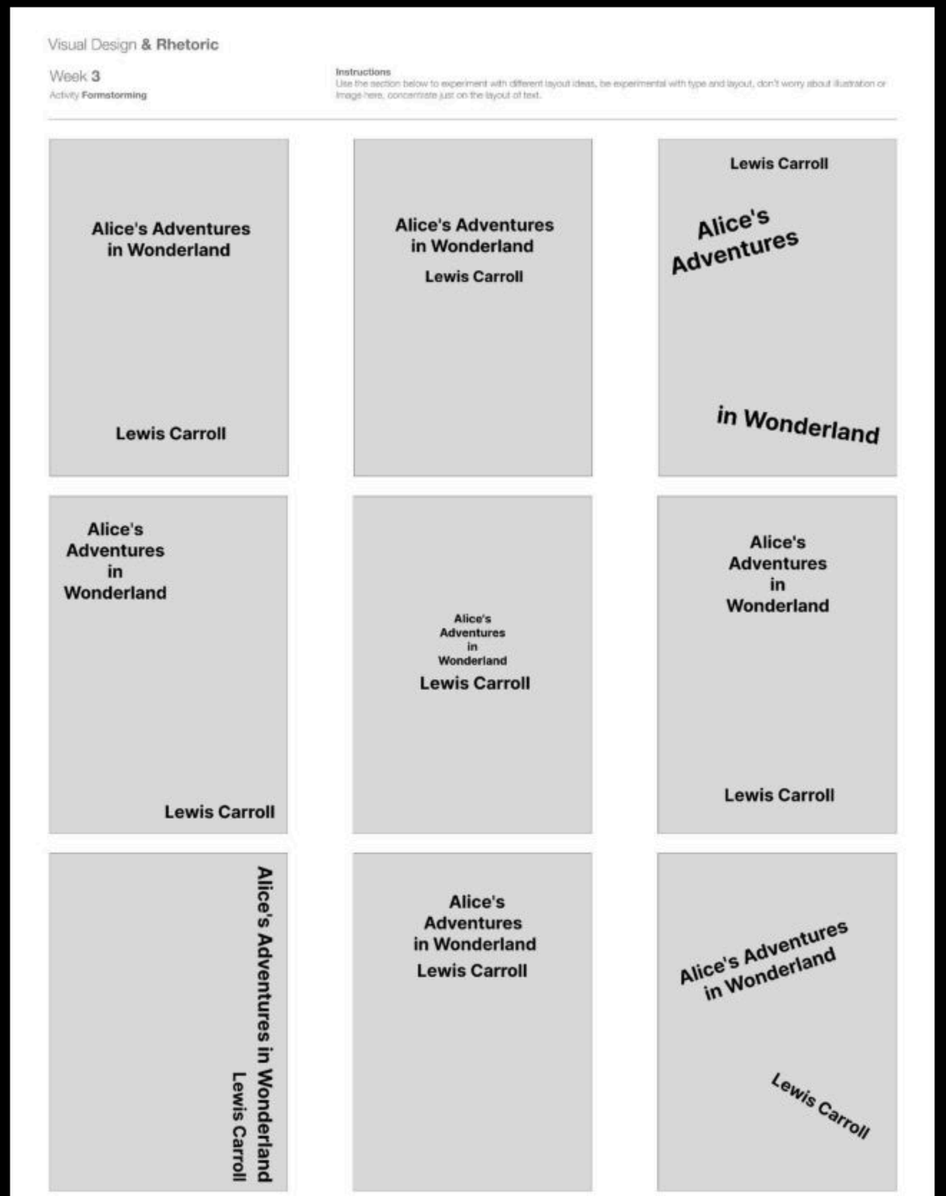
Dancing Script is an elegant and casual cursive script. Its strokes are smooth and dynamic, and the size and inclination of the letters are full of natural changes, as if they were written on the spur of the moment.

Why choose it:
I think this font has an unpredictable sense of fluidity, which can directly visualize the unpredictable and illogical characteristics in the wonderland. Just like the smile of the Cheshire Cat, it is elusive and hard to grasp. It can also metaphorically represent Alice's body constantly growing and shrinking in the wonderland, as well as her confusion about her own identity.



Process work

Art Direction





I arranged the words in an irregular path to echo Alice's unpredictable journey in the wonderland. However, due to the fixity of the cover, I will choose the first layout format as the final version.

Process work

Final Design

The title font I adopted is Irish Grover, which has a handcrafted and retro feel, in contrast to the elegant and casual handwritten Dancing Script.

I used the keyhole as the central composition element and visual focus of the entire cover.
The keyhole is a strong visual metaphor. It is not only the physical entrance for Alice to enter the wonderland, but also the narrative window for readers to explore the mysteries of the story, and more importantly, it symbolizes the critical point between reality and the subconscious, rationality and irrationality.



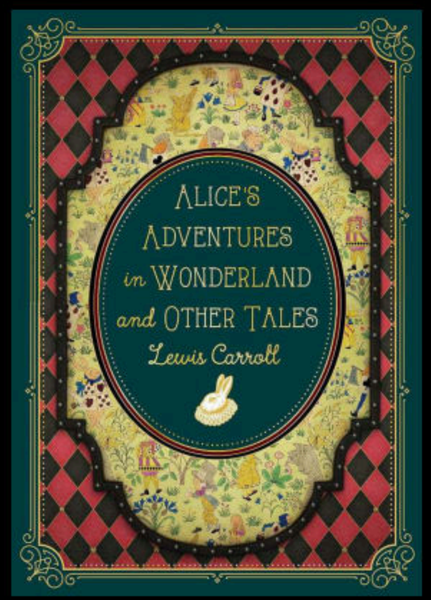
This element flow is a visual analogy of Alice's adventure journey. It is not a static list of scenes, but a dynamic and symbolic "map", hinting at the development of the story and the ups and downs of emotions.

My inspiration comes from the story. When Alice first followed the rabbit into the cave entrance, she ate the small cake and cookies inside, grew bigger and smaller, and then got the key. In my view, it is that key opening that is the origin of everything. Through this key opening, the door was opened, and thus one could enter that world. Only then can one meet the characters in the story. The roses respectively represent two queens. The thorns and leaves between them represent their attitudes towards each other. The picture also represents the order of the characters appearing, such as the rabbit, the clock, the cat, Alice, the Mad Hatted man, the book (Mr. Caterpillar), and the lanterns (everyone at the party), etc

Proposals







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Author: Lewis Carroll

Genre: Literary Nonsense, Fantasy, Children's Literature, Satire

Synopsis of the major themes:

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland tells the surreal journey of a young girl named Alice who impulsively follows a hurried white rabbit down a rabbit hole, plunging into a bizarre and fantastical world. In this upside-down realm governed by absurdity rather than logic, she encounters a series of eccentric characters, including the enigmatic Cheshire Cat, the Mad Hatter, and the tyrannical Queen of Hearts.

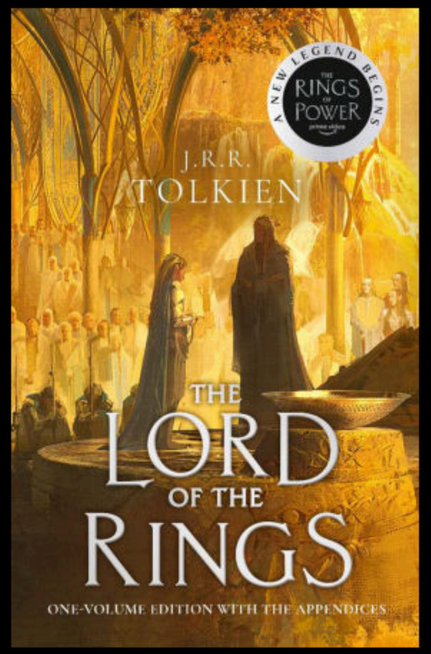
Throughout her bewildering adventures, Alice must navigate illogical challenges and shifting rules while grappling with an identity crisis triggered by randomly shrinking and growing after consuming various foods and potions. The novel presents a dazzling dreamscape that uses seemingly nonsensical whimsy to profoundly explore themes of childhood, curiosity, and the uneasy transition into adulthood.

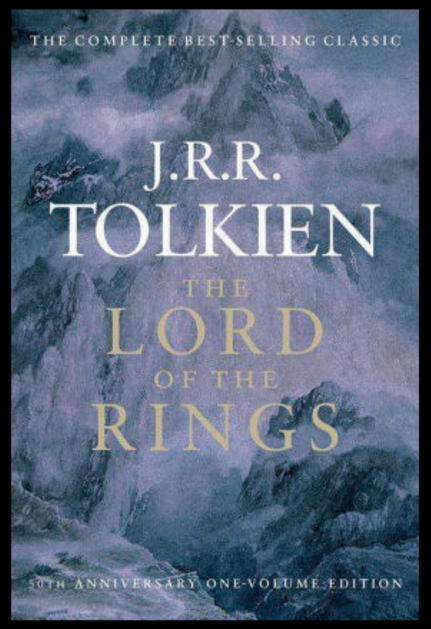
Why is this book of importance to you?

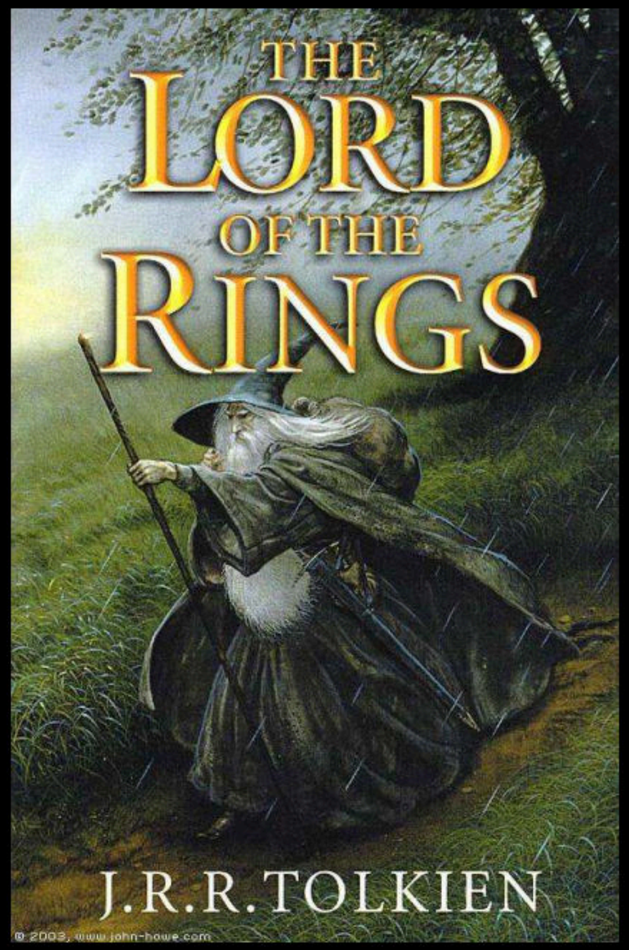
I think this book has taught me some truths about life. It encourages me to be as brave as Alice. It taught me that even if I'm afraid, I should keep a curious and brave heart to explore my own path. Rather than blindly accepting all the rules.

I think this book is more than just a fairy tale. It taught me in my childhood to view the world with curiosity and a critical eye, to see some absurd rules in it.

Proposals







Title: The Lord of the Rings

Author: John Ronald Reuel Tolkien

Genre: Epic Fantasy, High Fantasy, The Hero's Quest, Adventure Literature.

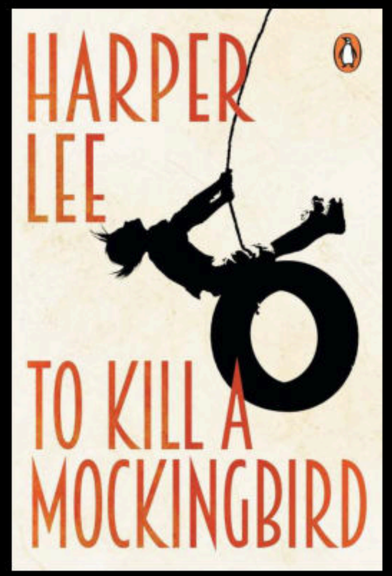
Synopsis of the major themes:

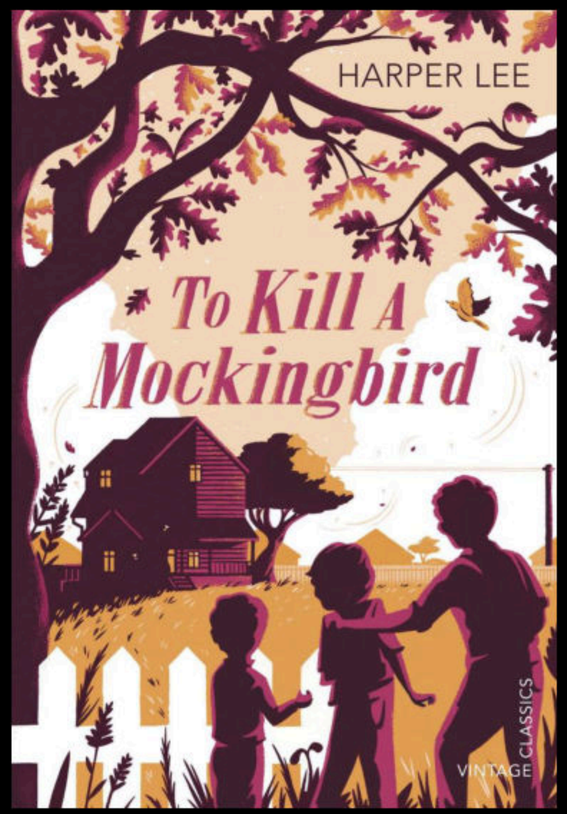
J.R.R. Tolkien's The Lord of the Rings stands as the foundational work of epic fantasy. The story begins with a seemingly ordinary ring, later revealed to be the One Ring forged by the Dark Lord Sauron, possessing the power to enslave the entire world. The fate of all free peoples in Middle-earth hinges upon the Ring's destruction. This burden unexpectedly falls upon the shoulders of the most ordinary of Hobbits, Frodo Baggins. He sets out with the Fellowship of the Ring—a band of wizards, elves, dwarves, and men—on a desperate journey to Mount Doom, the only place where the Ring can be destroyed. This quest is not only a war against external forces of darkness but also an internal struggle for the Ring-bearer against the temptation of power and the despair within. It is a grand epic about friendship, sacrifice, and the courage of the ordinary.

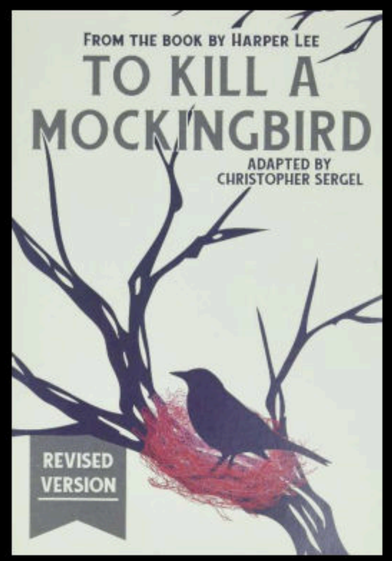
Why is this book of importance to you?

I think this book is not just a story to me, but a lesson about tenacity, responsibility and hope. It tells me that a true hero is not born strong, but rather, even if they are afraid or hurt, they will take on their responsibilities for the goodness of those they love and the world, and persist in walking the most difficult path.

Proposals







Title: To Kill a Mockingbird

Author: Harper Lee

Genre: Coming-of-age novels, social novels，Southern Gothic

Synopsis of the major themes:

Harper Lee's To Kill a Mockingbird examines racial injustice and moral dilemmas in a small Southern town during the Great Depression through the eyes of a young girl named Scout. Scout's father, lawyer Atticus Finch, defends Tom Robinson, a black man falsely accused of raping a white woman. This act thrusts their family into the vortex of prejudice and hatred. Meanwhile, Scout and her brother Jem are filled with both curiosity and fear toward their reclusive neighbor, "Booby" Radley. The novel profoundly explores empathy, courage, and justice. Atticus's teaching—that "you never really know a man until you walk a mile in his shoes"—becomes the spiritual core of the book. It is a coming-of-age story about upholding conscience and preserving kindness in a world rife with injustice.

Why is this book of importance to you?

It teaches people that they should bravely move towards understanding and tolerance.

This book is profoundly important to me because it serves as a moral anchor. It is not a simple tale of good versus evil, but a complex, painful, and deeply human lesson that teaches us how to view the world through the lens of justice and empathy.

Tropes



- Cover draft

Metaphor - Keyhole serves as the critical point between reality and fantasy, consciousness and subconsciousness.
Analogy - A sequence of elements flowing out of a keyhole, analogous to Alice's journey route map.
Metaphor - The red and white roses refer to (quote) the red and white queens in the story and their conflicts.
Irony - Using beautiful flowers (roses) to represent danger and conflict (thorns), creating a contrast between appearance and essence.
Exaggeration - Using huge and sharp thorns to exaggerate the hidden threats and the sharpness of satire in the story.

My redesigned cover for Alice's Adventures in Wonderland transforms the book itself into a visual gateway to the story's core themes. The central image is a keyhole—not merely an entrance, but a metaphor for the boundary between the rational, orderly world and the subconscious, absurd realm of Wonderland. Flowing from the keyhole is a sequential stream of character symbols, arranged in the order Alice encounters them. I treat this symbolic flow as an analogy for her journey itself, mapping her narrative path as a river flowing from its source.

For instance, the keyhole is encircled by intertwined red and white roses (the two Queens), their stems covered in thorns. This floral element serves a dual rhetorical purpose: it alludes to the story's iconic warring Queens, while the thorns introduce irony and exaggeration. I believe weaponizing delicate, beautiful flowers visually subverts expectations of a safe, whimsical fairy tale while exaggerating the latent threat permeating Wonderland. Throughout the composition, I avoided literal representation. Instead, I aimed to use these layered rhetorical devices to entice readers to “unlock” the story's themes of identity, logic, and the journey of growth.

Sources cited -Photo source

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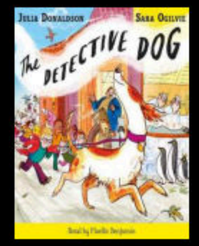
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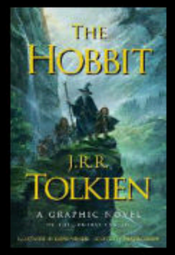
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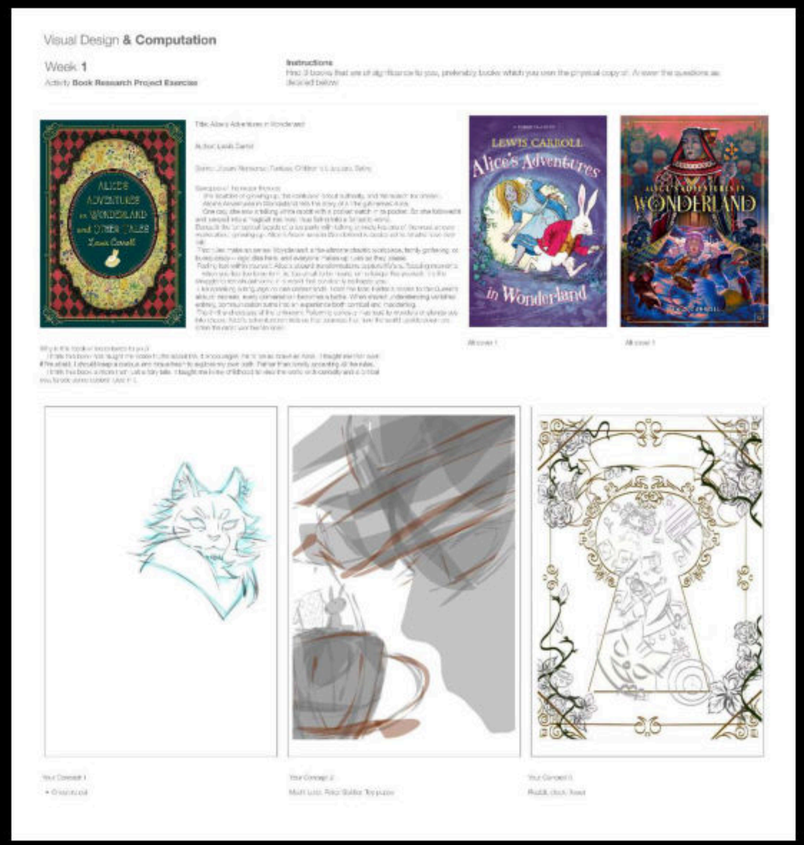
Appendix

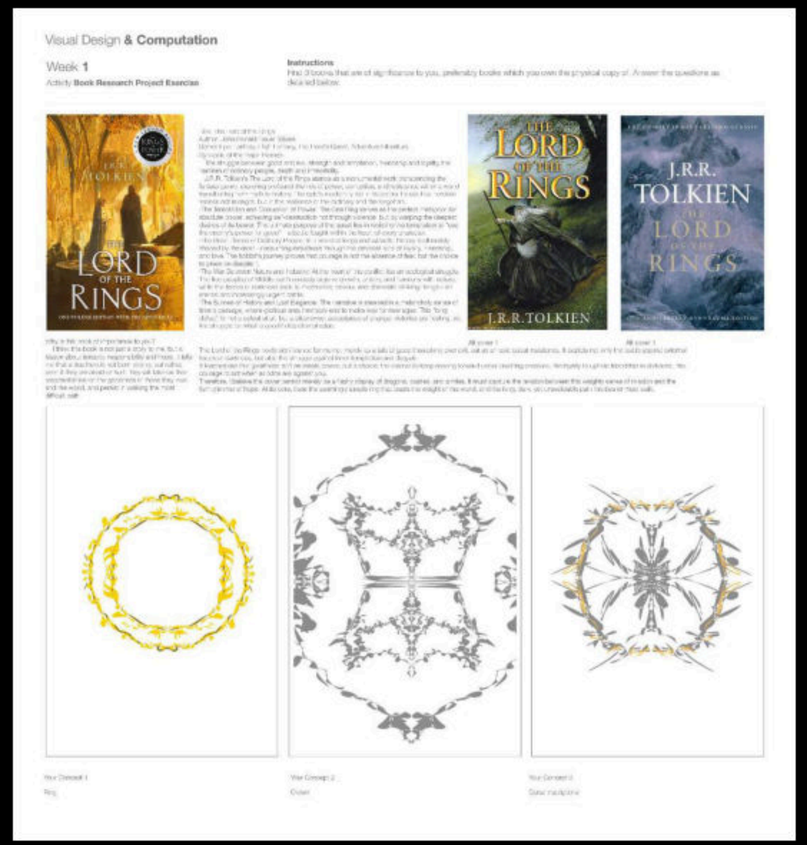


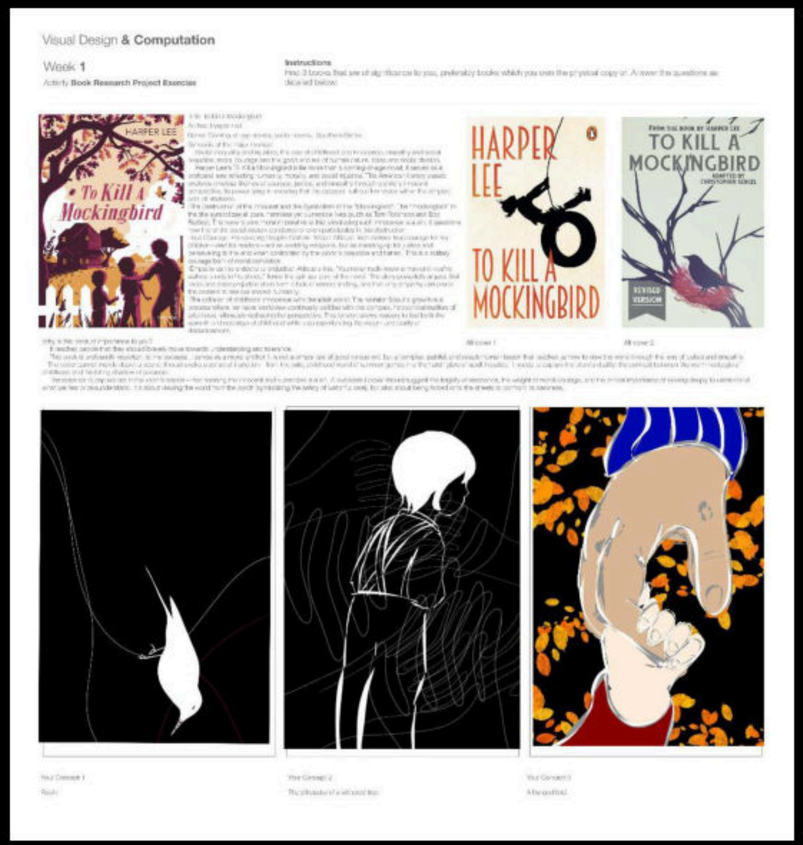












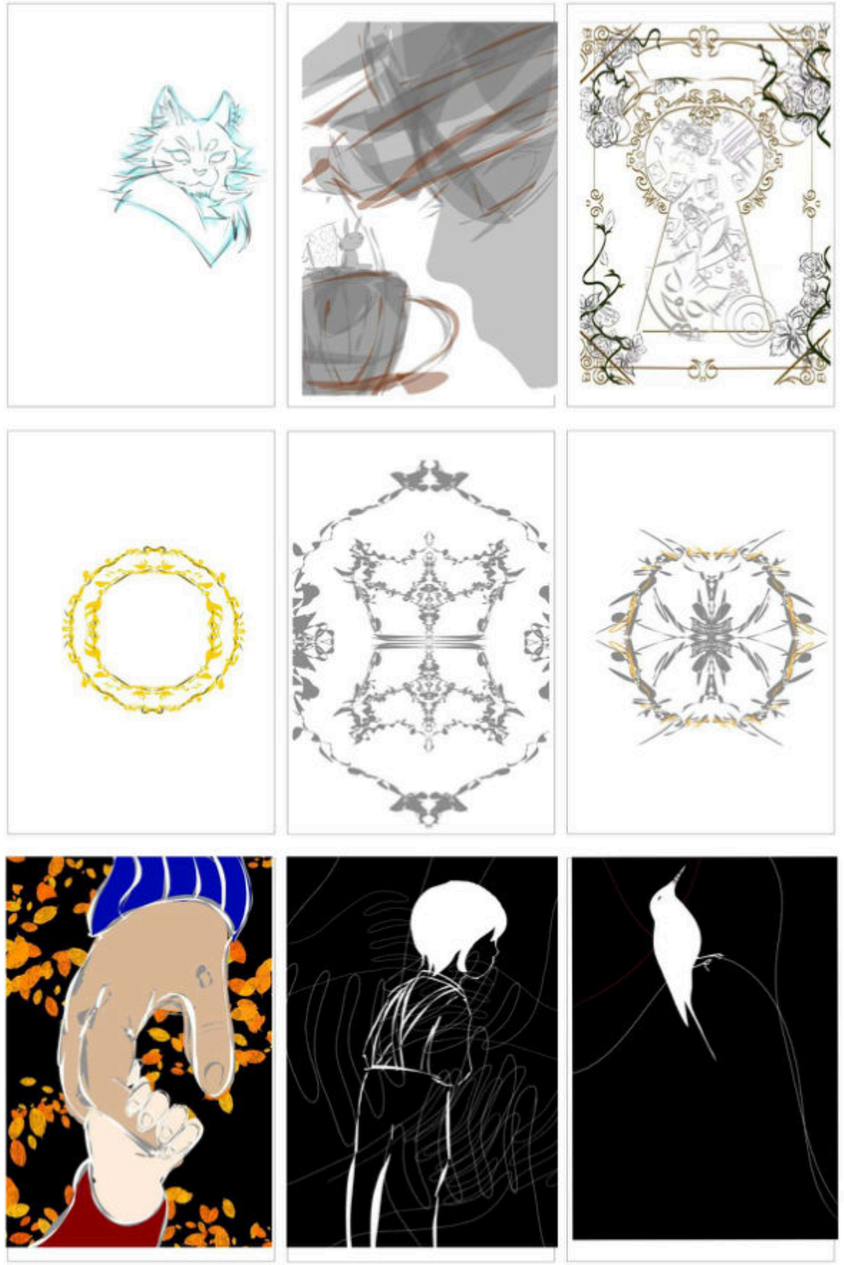
Book Research Project Exercise

Visual Design **& Computation**

Week **1**

Activity **Book Research Project Exercise**

Instructions
Collate all 9 pieces of work into one page to show your Form Storming



Book Research Project Exercise

Visual Design **& Computation**

Week **2**

Activity **Book Research Project Exercise**

Instructions
Find 3 books that are of significance to you, preferably books which you own the physical copy of. Answer the questions as detailed below:

Title: Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Author: Lewis Carroll

Genre: Literary Nonsense, Fantasy, Children's Literature, Satire

Synopsis of the major themes:
Alice's Adventures in Wonderland tells the surreal journey of a young girl named Alice who impulsively follows a hurried white rabbit down a rabbit hole, plunging into a bizarre and fantastical world. In this upside-down realm governed by absurdity rather than logic, she encounters a series of eccentric characters, including the enigmatic Cheshire Cat, the Mad Hatter, and the tyrannical Queen of Hearts.
Throughout her bewildering adventures, Alice must navigate illogical challenges and shifting rules while grappling with an identity crisis triggered by randomly shrinking and growing after consuming various foods and potions. The novel presents a dazzling dreamscape that uses seemingly nonsensical whimsy to profoundly explore themes of childhood, curiosity, and the uneasy transition into adulthood.



3 Initial concepts from last week



Your Refined Concept

Explain your project here

What Rhetorical Tropes will this use (delete those not being used)?

My redesigned cover for Alice's Adventures in Wonderland transforms the book itself into a visual gateway to the story's core themes. The central image is a keyhole—not merely an entrance, but a metaphor for the boundary between the rational, orderly world and the subconscious, absurd realm of Wonderland. Flowing from the keyhole is a sequential stream of character symbols, arranged in the order Alice encounters them. I treat this symbolic flow as an analogy for her journey itself, mapping her narrative path as a river flowing from its source.

For instance, the keyhole is encircled by intertwined red and white roses (the two Queens), their stems covered in thorns. This floral element serves a dual rhetorical purpose: it alludes to the story's iconic warring Queens, while the thorns introduce irony and exaggeration. I believe weaponizing delicate, beautiful flowers visually subverts expectations of a safe, whimsical fairy tale while exaggerating the latent threat permeating Wonderland. Throughout the composition, I avoided literal representation. Instead, I aimed to use these layered rhetorical devices to entice readers to "unlock" the story's themes of identity, logic, and the journey of growth.

Metaphor - Keyhole serves as the critical point between reality and fantasy, consciousness and subconsciousness.
Analogy - A sequence of elements flowing out of a keyhole, analogous to Alice's journey route map.
Metaphor - The red and white roses refer to (quote) the red and white queens in the story and their conflicts.
Irony - Using beautiful flowers (roses) to represent danger and conflict (thorns), creating a contrast between appearance and essence.
Exaggeration - Using huge and sharp thorns to exaggerate the hidden threats and the sharpness of satire in the story.

Refined Concepts

Visual Design **& Computation**

Week **2**

Activity **Book Research Project Exercise**

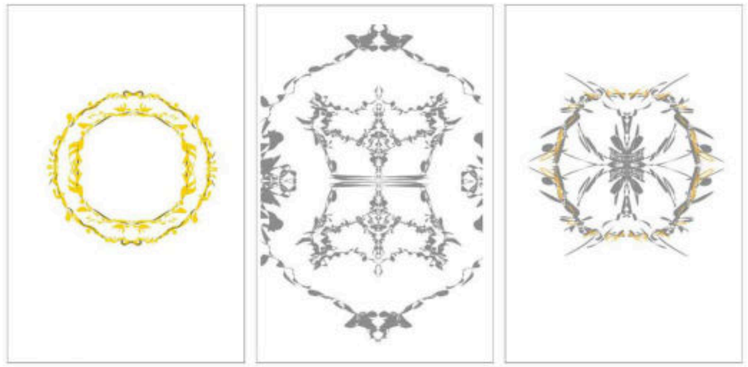
Instructions
Find 3 books that are of significance to you, preferably books which you own the physical copy of. Answer the questions as detailed below:

Title: The Lord of the Rings

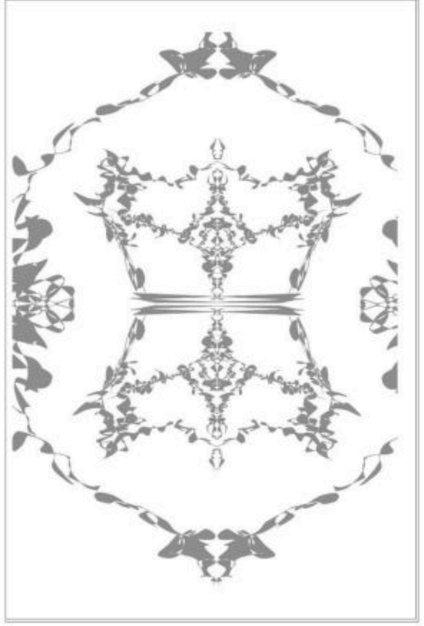
Author: John Ronald Reuel Tolkien

Genre: Epic Fantasy, High Fantasy, The Hero's Quest, Adventure Literature.

Synopsis of the major themes:
J.R.R. Tolkien's The Lord of the Rings stands as the foundational work of epic fantasy. The story begins with a seemingly ordinary ring, later revealed to be the One Ring forged by the Dark Lord Sauron, possessing the power to enslave the entire world. The fate of all free peoples in Middle-earth hinges upon the Ring's destruction. This burden unexpectedly falls upon the shoulders of the most ordinary of Hobbits, Frodo Baggins. He sets out with the Fellowship of the Ring—a band of wizards, elves, dwarves, and men—on a desperate journey to Mount Doom, the only place where the Ring can be destroyed. This quest is not only a war against external forces of darkness but also an internal struggle for the Ring-bearer against the temptation of power and the despair within. It is a grand epic about friendship, sacrifice, and the courage of the ordinary.



3 Initial concepts from last week



Your Refined Concept

Explain your project here

What Rhetorical Tropes will this use (delete those not being used)?

The cover I designed for "The Lord of the Rings" adopts a powerful metaphor: the vines form the shape of a crown. This visual effect indicates that the corrupting influence of the Ring is not merely the object of power, but the fundamental fracture of the world itself. The mirror image represents the greater dark side hidden beneath power. This sharp contrast analogizes the small and large central themes, as well as the immense weight of exploration. The interweaving of a sense of destiny, hope and despair.

The visual rhetorical devices used: metaphor, analogy, hyperbole

Visual Design **& Computation**

Week **2**

Activity **Book Research Project Exercise**

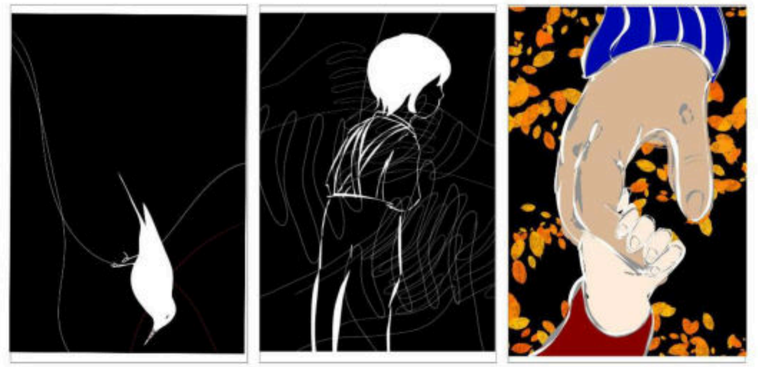
Instructions
Find 3 books that are of significance to you, preferably books which you own the physical copy of. Answer the questions as detailed below:

Title: To Kill a Mockingbird

Author: Harper Lee

Genre: Coming-of-age novels, social novels, Southern Gothic;

Synopsis of the major themes:
Harper Lee's To Kill a Mockingbird examines racial injustice and moral dilemmas in a small Southern town during the Great Depression through the eyes of a young girl named Scout. Scout's father, lawyer Atticus Finch, defends Tom Robinson, a black man falsely accused of raping a white woman. This act thrusts their family into the vortex of prejudice and hatred. Meanwhile, Scout and her brother Jem are filled with both curiosity and fear toward their reclusive neighbor, "Boo" Radley. The novel profoundly explores empathy, courage, and justice. Atticus's teaching—that "you never really know a man until you walk a mile in his shoes"—becomes the spiritual core of the book. It is a coming-of-age story about upholding conscience and preserving kindness in a world rife with injustice.



3 Initial concepts from last week



Your Refined Concept

Explain your project here

What Rhetorical Tropes will this use (delete those not being used)?

The cover of my "To Kill a Mockingbird" is based on a core metaphor: I incorporated elements of irony into the use of light and shadow. I set the frame in the silhouette of a child (Scout), visually equating her process of witnessing and understanding these injustices with the act of "growing up" itself. And the hand beside her represents these injustices, and it is also the reason why she cannot speak out. Warmth coexists with cruelty, and innocence confronts prejudice.

The visual rhetorical devices used: metaphor, analogy, irony

Refined Concepts

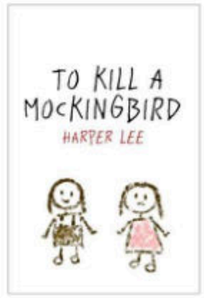
Visual Design **& Computation**

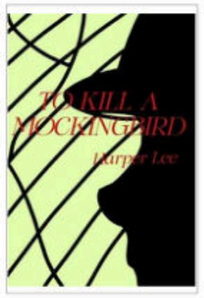
Week **2**

Activity **Experiment with ideas**

Instructions

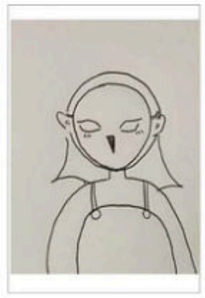
Choose the book you like the most from above. Experimentation is key to creating good design, in this formstorming exercise, try sketching out new ideas and previous ideas but change elements in your content such as people, perspective, aesthetics, go for many ideas. The goal is to consider other options that you didn't think of initially. Consider other rhetorical tropes. Work in rough not polished.

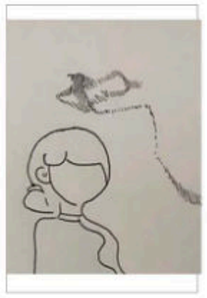






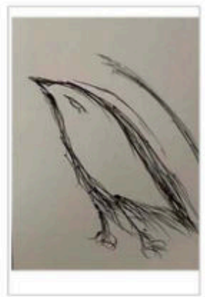




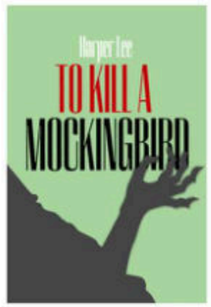






















Visual Design **& Computation**

Week **2**

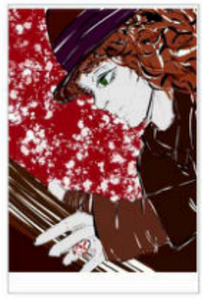
Activity **Experiment with ideas**

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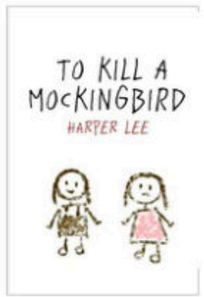


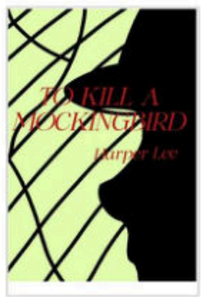


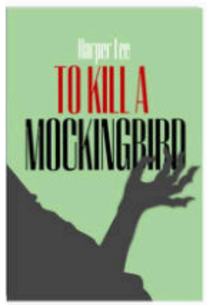


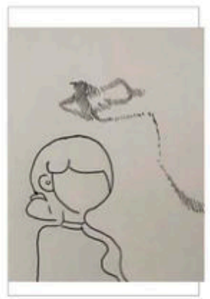














Refined Concepts

Visual Design **& Rhetoric**

Week **3**

Activity **Art Direction**

Instructions
Now research nine existing pieces of media (art, game, comic book, graphic novel, movie, animation) that have a **unique** design style.
Choose examples that will influence your artistic approach and direction.
Read this article on how an Art Director picks the cover for Orbit Publishing SF Books - https://www.muddycolors.com/2013/10/book-covers-illustration-vs-photo-vs-design/



Movie: "Zombie Bride" (2005)

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: I think Tim Burton presents the theme of death in such a melancholy, romantic and poetic way. Its pale and slender character designs, combined with the cold blue-green tones, create an aesthetic of a "beautiful freak".

Project impact: This film provided me with references for color tones and emotions in my design. It led me to envision a strange realm that does not win with bright colors but is created with deep blue, dark green, bone white and other colors, with a touch of sadness and a sense of the bizarre, perfectly echoing the hidden chaos and threat in the original work.



Movie: "Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: I think the visual signature of Tim Burton's version lies in the complexity and exaggeration of its Baroque style: the Mad Hatter's chaotic makeup, the Red Queen's huge head, and all kinds of strange and unconventional costumes.

Project impact: This film mainly influenced my thinking on character design. It encourages me to refine the character traits in an extreme and symbolic way. For instance, the Cheshire Cat might only be presented with a huge and misaligned smile, while the queens represent it by becoming the iconic rose, thus creating a striking visual focus amid the complexity.



Movie: "Pan's Labyrinth"

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: I think Guillermo del Toro seamlessly weaves the cruel reality with the cold and ancient fantasy. The fantasy creatures in it (such as Pan God and the Pale Monster) are not cute, but ancient, majestic and disturbing.

Project impact: I used the original novel of this film. This film has been of great help to my design inspiration. It strengthened my determination to present the "danger of the Wonderland" on the cover. For instance, I want to use details such as the thorns of roses and the metallic coldness of keyholes to infuse the cover with a stern poetic quality, clearly telling the audience that this is not an easy children's adventure.



Art: Surrealist paintings by Salvador Dalí

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: I think Dalí is more like directly depicting the dream itself. Its melted clocks, distorted Spaces and illogical juxtapositions are the products of the emergence of the subconscious after "rational sleep".

Project impact: This provided the most fundamental theoretical and visual basis for me to think about the core concept of "narrative elements flowing out of the keyhole". I think this is a typical surrealist technique, which can most directly visualize the core themes of logical disintegration, temporal and spatial distortion, and identity flow in the story, turning the cover into a "frozen dream".

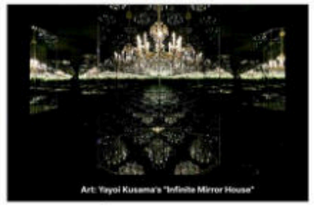


Animation: "Spider-Man: Into the Spider-Verse"

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: By watching this anime, I think the effect of creating a dynamic visual explosion that is "happening" by piecing together the dots of comics, the colors of pop art, and the fragmented feel of glitching art is very special.

Project impact: This anime has given me the courage to stylize and blend different visual elements.



Art: Yayoi Kusama's "Infinite Mirror House"

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: This artist creates an infinitely extending and self-dissolving visual space through highly reflective materials and repetitive polka dots, blurring the boundary between reality and illusion.

Project impact: This provided an excellent reference for the fragmented feeling I had when creating the cover background, which made me think of using a mirror effect to create a sense of confusion and dizziness.



Movie: "Midsommar"

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: By juxtsing the bright, splendid and folk pattern-filled "paradise" scene with the distressed expression of the figure in the center of the picture, an extremely disturbing beauty is created.

Project impact: I think this poster perfectly demonstrates how to create tension with "beautiful horror". This directly affected my handling of the red and white roses. I can paint them extremely beautifully and intricately, but the way they are entwined or the color combinations imply suffocation and conflict.



Album Cover: Radiohead "OK Computer"

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: I think the use of collage, distorted visual elements and chaotic layout inside is very special. It gives me a sense of anxiety, alienation and disorder created in the era of technology.

Project impact: It encouraged me to infuse a sense of "absurdity of the digital age" into my design. For instance, by combining some elements selected from the original work with the effect of minor glitch art, such as everyone falling down, it implies Alice's "overload" in the new world and the mental confusion of accepting the new society.



Movie: "Tenet"

Describe what is so unique about this and how it influences your project?

Uniqueness: I believe that the visual concept of "time inverse entropy" runs through the entire film, with both the forward and reverse movements of characters and the environment coexisting, creating a unique audio-visual language that defies common sense.

Project impact: This film has provided me with a new perspective for presenting that "time" theme on the cover. For instance, on the cover, the key theme of "time" can be visually conceptualized through a background of broken fragments or an exposed pocket watch.

Use these to guide the style of your book cover.

Visual Design **& Rhetoric**

Week **3**

Activity **Font Pairings**

Instructions
Write all of the text out that will appear on your cover front, back and sleeve.
Choose 2 fonts that work well together
Repeat twice more

Add all of the text below that will appear on your cover, choose 2 typefaces:

Figgles
Italianno
Corinthia
Dawning of a New Day
Jacques Francois

Add all of the text below that will appear on your cover, choose 2 typefaces:

Dai Banna SIL
Fleur De Leah

Add all of the text below that will appear on your cover, choose 2 typefaces:

Damion
Carattere
Birthstone Bounce
Explora
Bonheur Royale
Mrs Sheppards
Kerr Von Muellerhoff



Irish Grover

Dancing Script

https://www.monotype.com/
https://fonts.google.com/
https://www.fontsquirrel.com/
https://www.dafont.com/
https://www.fontspace.com/



Apply the best font pairing to your book design.

Art Direction

Visual Design & Rhetoric

Week 3

Activity **Formstorming**

Instructions

Use the section below to experiment with different layout ideas, be experimental with type and layout, don't worry about illustration or image here, concentrate just on the layout of text.

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Lewis Carroll

Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures

in Wonderland

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Lewis Carroll

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

Lewis Carroll

Art Direction

A daydream, a fantasia of logic, an enduring modern myth.

Little Alice chases a white rabbit, clutching a pocket watch, and tumbles into a bizarre wonderland. Here, she shrinks and grows, encounters a vanishing cat, a mad tea party, and the tyrannical Queen of Hearts... In this world where logic fails and rules are absurd, Alice's only weapons are her pure reason and curiosity.

Lewis Carroll's fantastical tale is far more than simple children's literature. It is a clever satire on Victorian social discipline, a philosophical inquiry into "Who am I?", and a funhouse mirror reflecting the absurdity of the adult world. For over a century, it has continually invited us to ask: Beneath the surface of madness, what constitutes true reason? Within the confines of rules, what defines the authentic self?

Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

by Lewis Carroll



A daydream, a fantasia of logic, an enduring modern myth.

Little Alice chases a white rabbit, clutching a pocket watch, and tumbles into a bizarre wonderland. Here, she shrinks and grows, encounters a vanishing cat, a mad tea party, and the tyrannical Queen of Hearts... In this world where logic fails and rules are absurd, Alice's only weapons are her pure reason and curiosity.

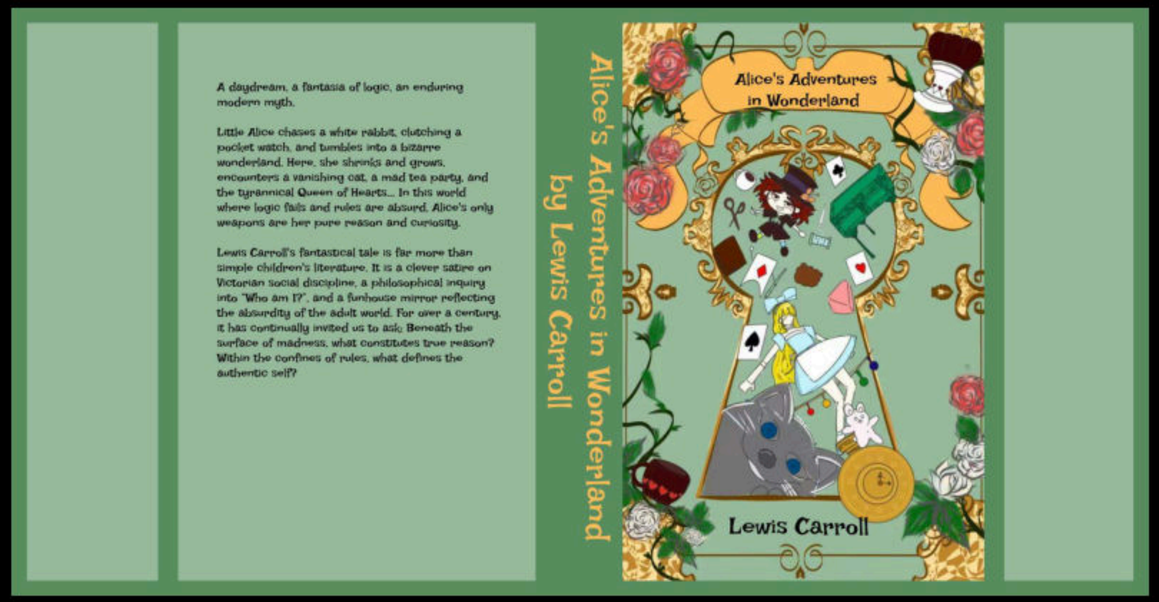
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Alice's Adventures in Wonderland

by Lewis Carroll

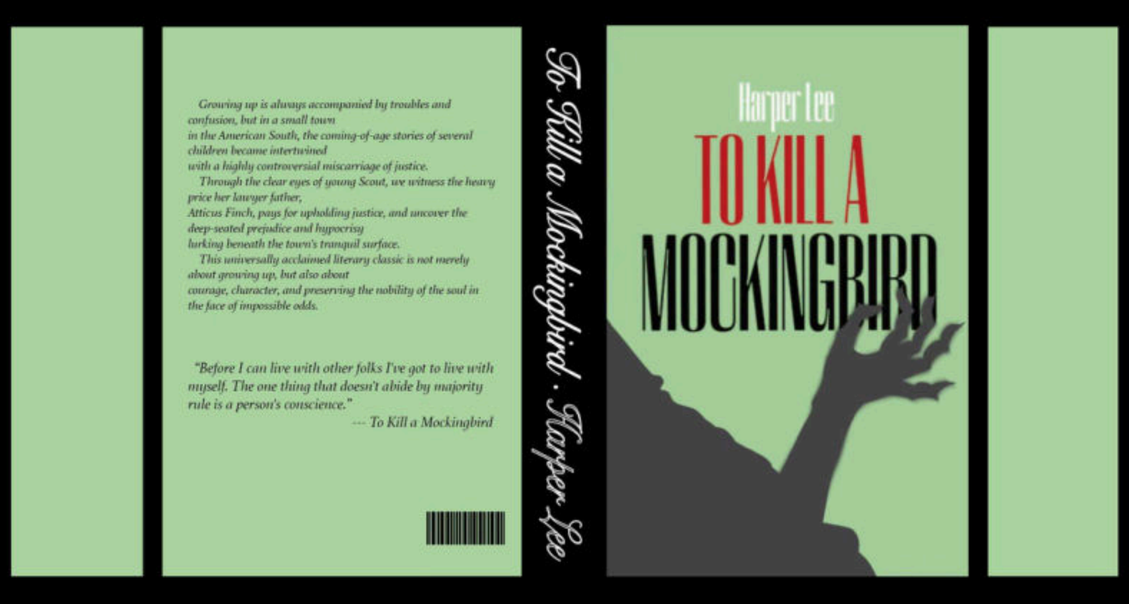


Apply the Design









Apply the Design

THANK YOU